

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Project Title: Employee Equipment Request Modernization

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1. Executive Summary

The company currently manages new employee equipment requests through email. As the company has grown, this informal process has produced incomplete requests, inconsistent approvals, limited status visibility, and delays that sometimes leave new employees without equipment on their start date.

Leadership is sponsoring an initiative to introduce a simple, standardized internal equipment request process. The desired outcome is a consistent intake experience for hiring managers, a centralized view of open requests for IT, a defined approval path for non-standard equipment, and basic reporting for leadership. The intent is to improve new hire readiness, reduce manual follow-up, and provide visibility into request status without replacing existing enterprise systems.

2. Version Control

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	7/6/2026	Darla Poling	Initial draft
1.1	7/7/2026	Darla Poling	Format updated, version control added.

3. Business Problem

The current email-based equipment request process creates delays, inconsistent information, and limited visibility into request status.

Specifically:

- Requests submitted by hiring managers are often missing key information such as start date or work location (remote, hybrid, in-office).
 - IT spends significant time following up with managers to complete incomplete requests.
 - There is no standard approval process for non-standard or upgraded equipment.
 - Managers cannot independently see the status of their requests and must email IT for updates.
 - IT tracks some, but not all, requests in spreadsheets, resulting in inconsistent recordkeeping.
 - New employees may not have their equipment ready on their first day.
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4. Business Objectives

1. Reduce the number of incomplete equipment requests submitted to IT.
 2. Improve visibility into equipment request status for both managers and IT.
 3. Reduce manual follow-up and back-and-forth communication between managers and IT.
 4. Improve new hire readiness by ensuring equipment is prepared before the employee's start date.
 5. Introduce a consistent approval path for non-standard equipment requests.
 6. Provide leadership with basic reporting on request volume and fulfillment timeliness.
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5. Current Process

Today, the equipment request process operates as follows:

- A hiring manager emails the IT team when a new employee needs equipment.
 - The email typically includes the employee's name, start date, role, office location, and requested equipment — but information is often incomplete.
 - When information is missing (for example, start date or work location), IT replies to the manager to request clarification.
 - Once IT has the required information, IT manually checks inventory.
 - If equipment is available, IT prepares it. If not, IT contacts the Procurement team to order it.
 - There is no standard approval process. When managers request extra or upgraded equipment, IT is not always sure whether the request has been authorized.
 - Managers frequently email IT for status updates because they have no other way to see progress.
 - IT tracks some requests in spreadsheets, but the tracking is inconsistent.
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6. Future Process

After the improvement is implemented, the process should operate as follows:

Hiring Managers will be able to:

- Submit an equipment request for a new employee using a standard form.
- Provide required employee information (including name, start date, and work location).
- Select needed equipment from a predefined standard list.
- Indicate whether the employee will be remote, hybrid, or in-office.
- Submit requests at least five business days before the employee's start date.
- View the status of their submitted requests without emailing IT.

IT Support will be able to:

- Receive complete request information at the point of submission.
- View all open equipment requests in one centralized place.
- Update request statuses as work progresses.
- Identify requests that require procurement.
- Track whether equipment has been prepared for the employee.

Leadership / Approvers will be able to:

- Review and approve requests for non-standard equipment.
- View basic reporting on request volume and fulfillment timeliness.

7. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / Interest
Hiring Managers	Submit equipment requests for new employees and track their status.
IT Support Team	Receive requests, prepare equipment, update status, and coordinate with procurement.
Procurement Team	Order equipment when inventory is unavailable.
New Employees	Receive equipment on or before their start date.
Department Leaders	Approve non-standard equipment requests and review reporting.
HR	Interested party in new hire readiness (specific involvement to be confirmed — see Open Questions).

8. Scope

In Scope

- A standard equipment request form.
- Required fields for key employee and equipment information.
- A request status tracking process.
- IT ability to update request status.
- An approval workflow for non-standard equipment.

- Basic reporting for leadership.

Out of Scope

- Automatically purchasing equipment from vendors.
 - Replacing the company's full asset management system.
 - Tracking equipment after it has been assigned to an employee.
 - Mobile app support.
 - Changes to HR onboarding systems.
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9. Assumptions

- Hiring managers are responsible for submitting equipment requests for their new employees.
 - IT is responsible for preparing and assigning standard equipment.
 - Procurement is responsible for ordering equipment when inventory is unavailable.
 - Non-standard equipment requests require approval before fulfillment.
 - The tools needed to support the new process are already available to the company.
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10. Constraints

- The first version of the solution must be simple enough to launch within 60 days.
 - The request process must use tools already available to the company.
 - Managers should not need special training to submit a request.
 - IT does not want to maintain multiple tracking spreadsheets after the new process launches.
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11. Risks

Risk	Description
Late Submissions	Managers may submit requests fewer than five business days before the employee's start date, impacting readiness.
Inventory Shortages	Requested equipment may not be available in inventory, requiring procurement and potentially delaying fulfillment.

Risk	Description
Approval Delays	Non-standard equipment approvals may take too long and delay the employee's readiness.
User Adoption	Managers may continue emailing IT instead of using the new standardized process.
Incomplete Requirements	Open questions (see Section 13) may impact scope or design if not resolved before build.
Reporting Gaps	Without defined reporting needs from leadership, reports may not meet expectations at launch.

12. High-Level Business Requirements

Requirement ID	Business Requirement
BR-001	The business needs a standard way for managers to submit employee equipment requests.
BR-002	The business needs required request information (including employee name, start date, and work location) to reduce incomplete submissions.
BR-003	The business needs managers to indicate whether the employee is remote, hybrid, or in-office.
BR-004	The business needs managers to select equipment from a predefined standard list.
BR-005	The business needs a justification to be provided for any non-standard equipment request.
BR-006	The business needs non-standard equipment requests to be routed for approval before fulfillment.
BR-007	The business needs IT to view all submitted equipment requests in one centralized place.
BR-008	The business needs IT to update the status of each request as work progresses.

Requirement ID	Business Requirement
BR-009	The business needs managers to view the status of their submitted requests without contacting IT.
BR-010	The business needs requests to be submitted at least five business days before the employee's start date.
BR-011	The business needs the ability to identify requests that require procurement action.
BR-012	The business needs leadership to view basic reporting on request volume and fulfillment timing.
BR-013	The business needs a defined set of request statuses (e.g., Submitted, Needs More Information, Pending Approval, Approved, In Progress, Waiting on Procurement, Ready for Pickup/Shipment, Completed, Cancelled).

13. Open Questions

1. Who is the designated approver for non-standard equipment requests?
2. What specifically qualifies as "standard" versus "non-standard" equipment?
3. Should HR be notified when equipment is marked Completed?
4. Should the system allow requests submitted fewer than five business days before the start date, and if so, under what conditions?
5. What specific reports and data fields does leadership need in the basic reporting view?
6. Should managers receive automated notifications when a request's status changes?
7. What is HR's specific role in this process, if any?
8. Should new employees receive any communication or visibility into their equipment status?
9. What is the process when a request is Cancelled — who can cancel and why?
10. Which existing company tools are expected to support this process?

14. Success Metrics

Metric	Description
Request Completeness Rate	Percentage of equipment requests submitted with all required information on the first submission.

Metric	Description
Follow-up Reduction	Reduction in the number of IT follow-up emails required to complete a request.
Manager Status Inquiries	Reduction in the number of status inquiry emails managers send to IT.
Fulfillment Timeliness	Percentage of new employees whose equipment is ready by their start date.
Average Fulfillment Time	Average time from request submission to request completion.
Reporting Availability	Leadership has access to basic reporting on request volume and fulfillment timing.